

Customer Profile:

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1. Hardware-to-Software (H2S) Companies

These are traditionally **Device Manufacturers** or **Intelligent Device Vendors** (IDVs) in industries like industrial automation, medical devices, and telecommunications.

- **The Challenge:** They suffer from "hardware commoditization" and low margins. They often manage thousands of separate SKUs for different hardware configurations, leading to supply chain bloat.
- **The Ideal Profile:**
 - **Maturity:** Established companies looking to shift value from the "box" to the "bits."
 - **Core Need: IP Protection and SKU Rationalization.** They want to ship one "standard" piece of hardware and use software licenses to unlock specific features (e.g., a medical imaging machine where "3D rendering" is a software-locked add-on).
 - **Thales Solution: Sentinel LDK** (License Development Kit) with **Hardware Keys** (HL) or **Software Keys** (SL) to protect against reverse engineering and tampering.

2. Hybrid Software Companies

These are typically **Independent Software Vendors (ISVs)** that have a large legacy install base of on-premises software but are currently building or acquiring cloud-based offerings.

- **The Challenge:** "License Fragmentation." They often have different systems to manage their old desktop licenses and their new cloud subscriptions, leading to a disjointed customer experience and "revenue leakage" where customers use more than they pay for.
- **The Ideal Profile:**
 - **Maturity:** Mid-to-large enterprises undergoing digital transformation.
 - **Core Need: A Single Source of Truth.** They need a unified "Entitlement Management" system that can issue a hardware dongle for a secure lab environment and a cloud login for a remote worker from the same back-office.
 - **Thales Solution: Sentinel EMS** (Entitlement Management System). It acts as the central hub that integrates with CRMs (like Salesforce) and ERPs to manage the entire lifecycle of a license, regardless of whether it's on-prem or in the cloud.

3. Pure SaaS & Cloud-Native Companies

These are companies born in the cloud, often providing high-volume apps, APIs, or AI services.

- **The Challenge:** Standard subscription models (flat monthly fees) are becoming less attractive than **Usage-Based (Consumption) models**. These companies need to track exactly how much a customer uses to bill them accurately and prevent account sharing.
- **The Ideal Profile:**
 - **Maturity:** Scale-ups and cloud-native enterprises focused on high growth and recurring revenue.
 - **Core Need: Agility and Insights.** They need to experiment with "freemium" tiers, "pay-as-you-go" models, or "feature-based" upsells without rewriting their application code every time.
 - **Thales Solution: Sentinel Cloud Licensing (SCL) and Usage Tracking.** This allows the vendor to see real-time data on feature adoption, which the sales team can use to identify "ready-to-upgrade" accounts.